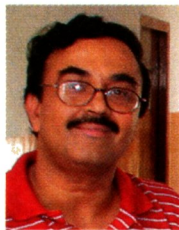


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WHAT THE FUTURE HOLDS



“I see more focus on entrepreneurial skills and a strategic mix of quantitative and soft skills.”

Saibal Chattopadhyay, Dean, IIM-Calcutta



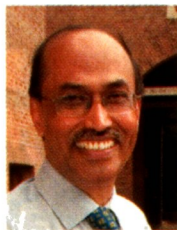
“Faculty and student exchange programmes will increase with globalisation.”

Dr P. Venugopal, Dean, Academics, XLRI



“The use of e-learning will be heavy. Technology is the way to be in the future.”

Rekha Sethi, Director General, AIMA



“I expect increasing involvement of the practicing world with the management schools.”

Samir K. Barua, Director, IIM-A



“Courses will be of relatively shorter duration and will definitely be more flexible.”

K. Ramachandran, Associate Dean, PGP, ISB, Hyderabad



“More co-joined dual degrees, international joint programmes will be the norm.”

Devi Singh, Director, IIM-Lucknow

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managers can contribute effectively. This “inclusive” MBA will prepare the candidates to work in tandem with the governments to resolve internal issues like poverty, pollution or environment in a business-like manner.

Shorter is smarter

Time is the most scarce resource and future MBA courses will be shorter in duration, providing flexibility to the candidates to be able to fulfil their respective requirements. Aspirants may even be given the liberty to go for modules instead of completing the course in one go. Says K. Ramachandran, associate dean, PGP, ISB, Hyderabad, “Modules will fa-

cilitate completion of course at your own convenience.” This means that you could do two modules in one year and the other two the subsequent year, depending how much time you have to spare.

People with work experience will be given preference in the future. Says Dr P. Venugopal, dean, academics, Xavier Labour Relations Institute (XLRI), Jamshedpur, “In the years to come, some minimum experience would be expected from the candidates so as to benefit from their industry-knowledge.” This will help prepare professionals who can cater to the industry requirements faster.

High on tech

MBA programmes will be equipped with the state-of-the-art methods to aid teaching. Already, games and simulations are a part of classroom teaching. The future will witness deeper penetration of technology. E-learning too will become a prominent trend.

Gauging the needs of the future, the IIMs have started offering online courses. Even the All India Management Association (AIMA) is set to launch an online course in financial planning and management next year. Live lectures via video-conferencing, availability of study material on the Internet, online lessons and distribution of pre-recorded lectures will be a done thing. Thus, technology will help tackle the problem of teacher shortage. Says Saibal Chattopadhyay, dean, IIM-Calcutta, “Real time teaching will be offered by experts using technology without the need of a ‘physical campus’. This would lead to a borderless, and possibly institutionless, teaching of management principles by experts from across the globe.”

The model of inviting practising managers as faculty will grow. Says Dr Chandrasekhar Chavan, director, Jamnalal Bajaj Institute of Management Studies, Mumbai, “Increased interface with the professional world means more involvement of practising managers.” As MBA becomes increasingly sought after, it should also become relevant if it wants to enjoy the status it does today. ■